

“Design This Hat with AI” button

Brief for the MadHats Shopify developer — MadHats AI Design Studio

Everything referenced here comes with this brief: `studio-button.liquid` (the snippet) and `README.md` (fuller install notes).

What it’s for

MadHats has a new **AI Design Studio** — a separate web app where a customer designs a cap on an interactive canvas (place a logo, add text, pick a decoration method), sees an AI-rendered photoreal mockup of that exact cap, and requests a quote. The button is the **entry point from the product page**: it hands the Studio the product the customer is already looking at, so they don’t re-pick it.

This does not replace InkyBay. InkyBay stays exactly as it is. The Studio button is an additional call-to-action alongside it.

What to do

1. Set `STUDIO_URL` at the top of `studio-button.liquid` to the host we give you (`https://`, no port, no trailing slash — staging first, prod at go-live).
2. Install it as either a snippet (`snippets/madhats-studio-button.liquid` + `{% render 'madhats-studio-button' %}`) or a **Custom Liquid** block in the theme editor. Your call — whichever fits the theme.
3. Place it on the product page under (or beside) Add to Cart. Restyle the `.madhats-studio-button` CSS to match the theme; the markup and the link are the parts that must stay intact.
4. Decide with us which products get it. It can be every cap, or gated on a tag / product type if we only want it on a subset.

Please don’t push to the live theme without a heads-up — we’ll confirm the store’s catalogue is synced first (see *If it doesn’t work* below).

How it should behave

- **Opens in a new tab** (`target="_blank" rel="noopener"`). The customer keeps their place on the storefront.
- **Carries the product**: the link’s `product_id` is `{{ product.id }}` — the numeric Shopify product id. Never substitute a hard-coded or internal id; the Studio resolves products by the Shopify id specifically.
- **Follows the variant selector**. The snippet’s inline script rewrites `variant_id` and `colour` in the link as the customer changes variant. If your theme’s selector is unusual and the script can’t hook it, it fails silent and the link keeps its server-rendered value (first available variant) — that’s acceptable, not a bug to chase.
- **Never interferes with Add to Cart**. It’s an `<a>`, not a `<button>`, so it is safe inside the product form — please keep it that way.

- **Carries no keys or customer data.** Just the product / variant / colour ids and `source=shopify`. Nothing to configure per-product.
- Works on mobile at the same place in the layout.

What success looks like

Click the button on a product page and you should land, in a new tab, **directly in the design canvas with that exact cap already loaded** — its real product photo, its colour, and the four face tabs (front / back / left / right) ready to design on. No product picker, no “choose a hat” step, no login.

Then check two more things:

- Change the variant on the product page **before** clicking — the Studio should open on the matching colourway.
- Try it on two different products — each should open its own cap.

If it doesn't work — you land on a “pick a product” screen: the link reached the Studio but the product wasn't recognised. Open the browser console; you'll see `[MadHats] bootstrapFromUrl failed`. **That is our side, not the theme** — it means either the product isn't in the Studio's synced catalogue yet or the Studio build is pointed at the wrong store. Send us the product URL and we'll fix it; nothing in the snippet needs changing.

Questions to send back to us

- Which products should show the button (all caps, or a tag / type subset)?
- Where in the product page do you want it, and do you want us to match a specific theme button style?
- Anything in the theme that would conflict with a new tab opening (a quick-view modal, a sticky ATC bar that re-renders the block, etc.)?